

Are you game?

Gaming, an industry which was considered to be dead in the early 80s, is now the most profitable industry among all entertainment businesses. With big players such as Microsoft, Sony and Nintendo entering the market, Gaming has grown to become a \$67 billion industry and is expected to reach \$112 billion by 2015. It will be bigger than Hollywood!

Even the Indian Gaming scenario has seen a vast change over the past 15 years. We now have an abundance of independent game studios trying their hands at making innovative games. With the count of MNCs going up in India, the job prospects have also risen and students no longer hesitate to choose Gaming as a career option.

With so much going on in the gaming industry, we're sure you want to know how it all works. That's what this Fast track tries to enlighten you about. There's hardly anyone who hasn't played a videogame in his entire life. In fact, some people spend their entire days and even nights playing video games. One such gaming enthusiast, Will Wright (the creator of *Sims*) claims that games were absorbing so much of his time, that he decided that maybe making games was the way to go. If you can connect to his story, then this is the right time to take the leap, seeing how well Gaming is doing right now.

We all love playing games, be it *Mario*, *Counter-Strike* or *Angry Birds*. Ever wondered how these games are developed? Is game development similar to software development? Making games requires a broad spectrum of skills such as programming, scripting, art, animation and music. Let's go into greater details of how the gaming industry can benefit and respond to everyone – right from investors and entrepreneurs to job seekers and gamers. 